

Flight Instructor - Airplane

Flight Lesson Guide

The student in this route is the instructor candidate; the instructor is the qualified trainer who can role-play a learner. The candidate prepares and teaches a measurable preflight lesson, demonstrates while explaining, supervises practice, diagnoses errors and assesses the result. Timing is an adjustable plan. Aircraft inspection/preparation, parked briefing and debrief are separate from the flight block; flight includes taxi, departure/transit, practice and safe return. Repeat or defer tasks until proficiency is demonstrated, and meet actual regulatory experience/endorsement requirements independently.

Original SUAREZ.CFI progression using FAA standards and handbooks; reviewed October 10, 2026. Instructor-route time allocations are teaching proposals.

Use this guide

Read the full teaching guide before flight. Use the compact checklist to sequence the flight. Minutes are pacing targets; repeat, stop, or defer an exercise when proficiency, conditions, or available time require it. Checkmarks indicate items covered, not a proficiency endorsement.

Aircraft values come from the applicable POH/AFM and approved checklist. Brief the aircraft-specific speeds, configurations, limitations, and any simulation method before conducting a maneuver.

Entry and preparation

- Meet applicable 14 CFR 61.183 eligibility, pilot-rating, knowledge-test, PIC-experience and endorsement requirements; the recommending instructor verifies records.
- Receive training from an instructor authorized and qualified for the initial certificate under 61.195, including the applicable initial-instructor qualification provisions.
- Complete FOI, technical subject and preflight-preparation study before the corresponding candidate-taught lesson; use current FAA references rather than this flight guide as a full ground syllabus.
- Verify the applicable 61.183(i) spin-training/endorsement requirement using a separately suitable approved aircraft and qualified instructor.
- This authored flight sequence covers ASEL. ASES or a different existing-rating pathway needs its own applicable class tasks and additional-rating table review.

Sources and alignment

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024; effective May 31, 2024; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020); FAA index reviewed October 10, 2026

Airplane Flying Handbook and current addenda - FAA-H-8083-3C (2021), October 2025 addendum listed; index reviewed October 10, 2026

Flight instructor eligibility and proficiency rules - Current eCFR; verify for the specific applicant

Certification and endorsement guidance - AC 61-65K, November 2025; verify current FAA status before endorsement

Lesson index

Foundations of flight instruction

- 1 · Transition from pilot to instructor · 90 min dual
- 2 · Teach the four fundamentals · 90 min dual
- 3 · Teach slow flight and approach/departure stalls · 90 min dual
- 4 · Teach the airplane's ground track · 90 min dual
- 5 · Coach normal pattern operations · 90 min dual

Task instruction and learner-error diagnosis

- 6 · Teach short/soft-field operations and slips · 90 min dual
- 7 · Teach abnormal systems and a simulated forced landing · 90 min dual
- 8 · Teach steep turns, a spiral and power-off accuracy · 90 min dual
- 9 · Teach chandelles and the two different eights · 90 min dual
- 10 · Teach stall demonstrations and safe learner boundaries · 90 min dual
- 11 · Teach basic instrument control and unusual-attitude recovery · 90 min dual

Integration, specialized training and stage assessment

- 12 · Integrate teaching and repair weak elements · 120 min dual
- 13 · Complete spin instruction in a suitable airplane · 90 min dual
- 14 · Stage assessment: teach, supervise and diagnose · 120 min check

Mission management and practical-test preparation

- 15 · Manage an instructional mission · 120 min dual
- 16 · Mock instructor practical test · 120 min check

Foundations of flight instruction

Establish safe instructor-seat flying and the demonstration-performance teaching cycle.

Lesson 1 · Transition from pilot to instructor

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-42 Air 12-36	[] Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals	State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent.
42-56 Air 36-50	[] Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control	Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction.
56-70 Air 50-64	[] Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment	Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 1

Establish safe instructor-seat control, positive exchanges and concise explanations before adding learner role-play.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Establish safe instructor-seat control, positive exchanges and concise explanations before adding learner role-play.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify instructor-seat proficiency, aircraft controls/checklists and training-instructor qualifications.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Establish safe instructor-seat control, positive exchanges and concise explanations before adding learner role-play.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate one change at a time: attitude, power, then trim. Give the candidate a desired flight path rather than a control command. Act as a learner who chases an instrument; require the candidate to redirect attention to an outside reference and then verify the result.

Student exercise: State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent. Hand over positively, coach the role-play learner through the same sequence, and ask the learner to explain which change produced the observed result.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one coached learner attempt of each fundamental; prioritize a weak item for the remaining time.

Look for: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Watch / correct: Trimming before establishing the attitude/power combination -> stabilize the airplane first and then trim.

Watch / correct: Continuous instrument fixation -> restore an outside attitude reference and use the instruments to confirm it.

Stop / transition: Stop the exercise for uncoordinated control, an unsafe flight path, traffic conflict or loss of role clarity; reestablish ordinary flight before further explanation.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VIII.A-D; AFH chapter 3

Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to brief the applicable bank target, entry speed, power and limitation from the ACS/aircraft documents. Demonstrate a safe learner tendency to lose altitude by discussing it or making only a small recoverable deviation.

Student exercise: Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction. Explain attitude, back-pressure, power and trim management, then coach a learner through a turn and rollout to the starting heading.

Practice: One demonstration each direction; one coached attempt in the weaker direction; reset between turns.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable commercial/instructor task standard and diagnoses the cause of altitude/airspeed deviations while retaining coordination and lookout.

Watch / correct: Adding more bank to correct an altitude loss -> diagnose the load/attitude problem before the correction.

Watch / correct: Rolling out late while explaining -> lead the rollout and divide attention between instruction and the flight path.

Stop / transition: Stop for aircraft load/speed limit, loss of coordination, significant flight-path deterioration or traffic conflict. The instructor takes control before the learner error becomes unsafe.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.A; AFH chapter 10

Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the candidate brief pattern entry, wind correction, runway choice, stabilized approach criteria and a positive control-transfer plan. Act as a learner who overlooks a checklist or misjudges spacing; use a verbal prompt instead of creating an unsafe approach.

Student exercise: Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures. Demonstrate one approach, coach the next, explain workload management and make a planned go-around. Make the landing/go-around decision early enough to preserve options.

Practice: One demonstration circuit, one coached circuit and one planned go-around as traffic/ATC permit; no forced pattern count.

Look for: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Watch / correct: Talking through final while losing airspeed/alignment -> shorten instruction, regain a stabilized approach or go around.

Watch / correct: Treating an ATC instruction as permission to exceed a limit -> request an alternative and protect the aircraft margin.

Stop / transition: Go around or discontinue for an unstable approach, unsafe spacing, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or unclear control responsibility. Touch-and-go operations require aircraft/airport authorization.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.A-B and VII.A-B,N; AFH chapters 6, 8-9

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Focus the first flight on flight-path reliability; a full steep-turn teaching evaluation is deferred if instructor-seat control is not yet stable.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, IX.A, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.N; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 2 · Teach the four fundamentals

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90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-54 Air 12-48	[] Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals	State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent.
54-70 Air 48-64	[] Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment	Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 2

Build a repeatable demonstration-performance lesson and teach a normal transition back to the airport.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Build a repeatable demonstration-performance lesson and teach a normal transition back to the airport.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare a short preflight lesson with a measurable outcome for each fundamental.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Build a repeatable demonstration-performance lesson and teach a normal transition back to the airport.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals · 36 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate one change at a time: attitude, power, then trim. Give the candidate a desired flight path rather than a control command. Act as a learner who chases an instrument; require the candidate to redirect attention to an outside reference and then verify the result.

Student exercise: State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent. Hand over positively, coach the role-play learner through the same sequence, and ask the learner to explain which change produced the observed result.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one coached learner attempt of each fundamental; prioritize a weak item for the remaining time.

Look for: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Watch / correct: Trimming before establishing the attitude/power combination -> stabilize the airplane first and then trim.

Watch / correct: Continuous instrument fixation -> restore an outside attitude reference and use the instruments to confirm it.

Stop / transition: Stop the exercise for uncoordinated control, an unsafe flight path, traffic conflict or loss of role clarity; reestablish ordinary flight before further explanation.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VIII.A-D; AFH chapter 3

Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the candidate brief pattern entry, wind correction, runway choice, stabilized approach criteria and a positive control-transfer plan. Act as a learner who overlooks a checklist or misjudges spacing; use a verbal prompt instead of creating an unsafe approach.

Student exercise: Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures. Demonstrate one approach, coach the next, explain workload management and make a planned go-around.

Make the landing/go-around decision early enough to preserve options.

Practice: One demonstration circuit, one coached circuit and one planned go-around as traffic/ATC permit; no forced pattern count.

Look for: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Watch / correct: Talking through final while losing airspeed/alignment -> shorten instruction, regain a stabilized approach or go around.

Watch / correct: Treating an ATC instruction as permission to exceed a limit -> request an alternative and protect the aircraft margin.

Stop / transition: Go around or discontinue for an unstable approach, unsafe spacing, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or unclear control responsibility. Touch-and-go operations require aircraft/airport authorization.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.A-B and VII.A-B,N; AFH chapters 6, 8-9

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Carry the weakest fundamental into the next flight; do not introduce stalls before coordinated aircraft control is reliable.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.N; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 3 · Teach slow flight and approach/departure stalls

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90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-38 Air 12-32	[] Teach slow flight and configuration effects	Clear the area; establish the approved configuration and briefed task condition.
38-54 Air 32-48	[] Teach a power-off stall and its recovery	Clear the area, verify recovery altitude and aircraft authorization, and establish the approved approach configuration.
54-70 Air 48-64	[] Teach a power-on stall without hiding the yaw risk	Clear the area and set the authorized departure configuration/power.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 3

Teach aerodynamic cues and recovery priorities while keeping demonstration and learner practice distinct.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach aerodynamic cues and recovery priorities while keeping demonstration and learner practice distinct.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Brief applicable slow-flight task, stall recovery condition, authorized configuration and recovery margins.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach aerodynamic cues and recovery priorities while keeping demonstration and learner practice distinct.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach slow flight and configuration effects · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate name the selected ACS slow-flight task, its configuration and recovery criterion before changing configuration. Demonstrate changing drag/power while preserving coordination. Role-play fixation on airspeed so the candidate must coach attitude, coordination and warning recognition. Distinguish maneuvering-during-slow-flight task X.A from the separate ASEL configuration/airspeed demonstration X.B; set the applicable cue/recovery criterion for each before beginning.

Student exercise: Clear the area; establish the approved configuration and briefed task condition. Explain how control response and power requirements change; demonstrate straight flight, a turn, climb and descent as applicable. Coach a learner attempt and return to the normal configuration using the aircraft checklist. For the separate X.B demonstration, compare handling, required power, pitch/trim, control response and stall margin in the applicable cruise, climb, approach and landing configurations/airspeeds using approved aircraft targets; explain the practical implication of each transition.

Practice: One demonstration sequence; one coached sequence; one short diagnosis of a deliberately small, safe deviation. The X.B configuration comparison is a separate observed demonstration; defer/repeat it if adequate safe practice does not fit.

Look for: Candidate teaches the distinction between slow-flight tasks, uses the appropriate warning/recovery criterion, and maintains applicable ACS tolerances with coordinated control.

Watch / correct: Treating the stall-warning condition as the same for every slow-flight task -> restate the selected task criterion.

Watch / correct: Trying to climb with pitch alone -> compare the flight-path and airspeed indications, then make the approved power/attitude change.

Stop / transition: Recover for an unbriefed stall indication, degraded directional control, traffic conflict or reaching the applicable recovery floor. Never continue merely to consume the block.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.A-B and Appendices 2-3; AFH chapter 5

Teach a power-off stall and its recovery · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief whether recovery is at the first indication or after a full stall, as applicable. Observe the candidate explain an approach-to-landing setup. Act as a learner who tries to hold the nose up during recovery; require prompt explanation of angle-of-attack reduction.

Student exercise: Clear the area, verify recovery altitude and aircraft authorization, and establish the approved approach configuration. Explain the developing cues during entry. Recover using the aircraft procedure, regain controlled flight, clean up as appropriate, then coach one learner attempt.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one coached attempt; repeat only if the recovery remains controlled and the planned altitude margin is available.

Look for: The candidate recognizes the briefed stall condition, reduces angle of attack promptly, maintains coordination, and explains the recovery while meeting the applicable ACS standard.

Watch / correct: Watching only the airspeed indicator -> identify aerodynamic and warning cues throughout entry.

Watch / correct: Retraction or pitch changes that cause a second stall -> stabilize recovery and follow the approved configuration sequence.

Stop / transition: Terminate for yaw/incipient spin, a recovery-floor threat, an unbriefed full stall, aircraft limitation, or a trainer intervention. Review the cause before another attempt.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.C and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Teach a power-on stall without hiding the yaw risk · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to brief approved power and configuration, pitch limits if applicable, and recovery cues. Watch the candidate explain the coordination demand. Introduce an oral learner misconception about correcting yaw with aileron; do not create a hazardous physical error.

Student exercise: Clear the area and set the authorized departure configuration/power. Explain the changing control pressures and stall cues, demonstrate the briefed recovery, and coach a coordinated learner attempt. Compare the departure-stall risk with the earlier approach-stall lesson.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached attempt; one verbal yaw-error diagnosis.

Look for: Candidate maintains directional control, detects the chosen stall cue, recovers by the approved procedure, and gives an accurate explanation while flying.

Watch / correct: Increasing pitch without monitoring coordination -> restore coordinated control and reassess the entry.

Watch / correct: Explaining during a developing loss of control -> recover first, then discuss the cue.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for unbriefed yaw/roll, impending spin, an exceeded aircraft limit, or insufficient recovery margin. Do not reproduce a hazardous learner error.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.D and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches the distinction between slow-flight tasks, uses the appropriate warning/recovery criterion, and maintains applicable ACS tolerances with coordinated control.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.

- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Repeat a weak stall/slow-flight element in a later flight rather than rushing recovery or skipping the reset.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks X.A, X.B, X.C, X.D; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 4 · Teach the airplane's ground track

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-54 Air 12-48	[] Teach wind correction through ground-reference maneuvers	Brief and demonstrate a rectangular course, S-turns or turns around a point as assigned.
54-70 Air 48-64	[] Teach eights on pylons without trading away altitude margin	Demonstrate the approved pylon selection and entry, explain the visual reference movement, and coach a learner through one pair.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 4

Connect wind, groundspeed and visual references to coordinated ground-reference instruction.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Connect wind, groundspeed and visual references to coordinated ground-reference instruction.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Select safe practice references and review the wind/terrain/people/property constraints.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Connect wind, groundspeed and visual references to coordinated ground-reference instruction.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach wind correction through ground-reference maneuvers · 36 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to select a legal, suitable ground reference and explain wind, traffic, emergency landing options and altitude risks. Role-play a learner who corrects drift with rudder instead of a coordinated bank change.

Student exercise: Brief and demonstrate a rectangular course, S-turns or turns around a point as assigned. Explain wind-dependent bank changes and reference selection, coach a learner attempt, and compare the aircraft track with the intended ground path.

Practice: Two selected reference maneuvers: one demonstrated and one coached circuit each; the remaining variant is carried to review if time is insufficient.

Look for: Candidate maintains applicable ACS limits, keeps an outside scan and teaches the relationship between ground track, wind and bank without fixation on the point.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the reference -> restore the traffic/terrain scan and broaden the visual picture.

Watch / correct: Using a fixed bank around the entire ground path -> identify where groundspeed changes and adjust coordinated bank.

Stop / transition: Leave the exercise for unsuitable terrain/obstructions, people/property risk, traffic, an unavailable emergency option or a breached altitude margin; do not descend to make the diagram look better.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.E; AFH chapter 7

Teach eights on pylons without trading away altitude margin · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Require suitable pylons, a safe operating area, wind assessment and emergency options. Ask the candidate to explain the groundspeed-related pivotal-altitude concept using actual units and the applicable guidance. Never use the exercise to justify unsafe low flight.

Student exercise: Demonstrate the approved pylon selection and entry, explain the visual reference movement, and coach a learner through one pair. Adjust the flight path as appropriate while preserving coordination, traffic scan and safe terrain separation.

Practice: One candidate pair and one coached pair if conditions permit; otherwise complete the explanation and defer the required flight practice.

Look for: Candidate keeps the intended visual reference relationship without fixation and can explain the effect of groundspeed on the required flight path.

Watch / correct: Using one computed altitude regardless of groundspeed -> connect changing groundspeed to the reference movement.

Watch / correct: Chasing a pylon downward toward terrain -> abandon the maneuver and select a safer setup.

Stop / transition: Exit for unsuitable terrain/pylon spacing, traffic, lack of safe forced-landing options or loss of terrain margin. No universal operational altitude is supplied.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.F; AFH chapter 10

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains applicable ACS limits, keeps an outside scan and teaches the relationship between ground track, wind and bank without fixation on the point.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Ground-reference variants or required pylon practice not demonstrated safely are assigned to lessons 9 or 12.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks IX.E, IX.F; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 5 · Coach normal pattern operations

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-70 Air 12-64	[] Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment	Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 5

Demonstrate once, coach the trainer as learner, and teach when a go-around is the correct decision.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Demonstrate once, coach the trainer as learner, and teach when a go-around is the correct decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Review local pattern/ATC procedures, wind/runway choice and aircraft-specific stabilized approach criteria.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Demonstrate once, coach the trainer as learner, and teach when a go-around is the correct decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment · 52 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the candidate brief pattern entry, wind correction, runway choice, stabilized approach criteria and a positive control-transfer plan. Act as a learner who overlooks a checklist or misjudges spacing; use a verbal prompt instead of creating an unsafe approach.

Student exercise: Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures. Demonstrate one approach, coach the next, explain workload management and make a planned go-around. Make the landing/go-around decision early enough to preserve options.

Practice: One demonstration circuit, one coached circuit and one planned go-around as traffic/ATC permit; no forced pattern count.

Look for: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Watch / correct: Talking through final while losing airspeed/alignment -> shorten instruction, regain a stabilized approach or go around.

Watch / correct: Treating an ATC instruction as permission to exceed a limit -> request an alternative and protect the aircraft margin.

Stop / transition: Go around or discontinue for an unstable approach, unsafe spacing, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or unclear control responsibility. Touch-and-go operations require aircraft/airport authorization.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.A-B and VII.A-B,N; AFH chapters 6, 8-9

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Carry any unavailable crosswind demonstration or interrupted landing repetition to a later suitable day.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.N; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Task instruction and learner-error diagnosis

Teach maneuver families, abnormal events and basic instruments with clear supervision and recovery boundaries.

Lesson 6 · Teach short/soft-field operations and slips

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-28 Air 12-22	[] Teach short-field takeoff planning and execution	Explain configuration, runway use, approved target speeds and obstacle-clearance path.
28-40 Air 22-34	[] Teach short-field landing and a safe go-around choice	Brief and fly a stabilized short-field approach with the approved configuration and speeds.
40-50 Air 34-44	[] Teach soft-field takeoff technique and surface decisions	Demonstrate the approved control positioning and liftoff/acceleration profile, then coach a learner attempt.
50-60 Air 44-54	[] Teach soft-field landing without losing control	Demonstrate or coach a stabilized soft-field approach, touchdown and rollout using the aircraft procedure.
60-70 Air 54-64	[] Teach forward slip, sideslip and landing limitations	At a suitable altitude, demonstrate the authorized slip and recover to coordinated flight.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 6

Teach the differences between runway/surface-specific techniques without repeating a full normal-pattern lecture.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach the differences between runway/surface-specific techniques without repeating a full normal-pattern lecture.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare actual takeoff/landing performance and verify surface, slip and configuration authorization.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach the differences between runway/surface-specific techniques without repeating a full normal-pattern lecture.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach short-field takeoff planning and execution · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Require an actual performance calculation with the selected weight, weather, runway and obstacles. Ask the candidate to compare available distance with the approved takeoff/obstacle profile and to identify reject/continue decisions from the aircraft and conditions.

Student exercise: Explain configuration, runway use, approved target speeds and obstacle-clearance path. Demonstrate or coach the assigned short-field takeoff; verify the flight path and checklist transition after obstacle clearance. Teach why a computed capability is not a reason to accept inadequate margin.

Practice: One assigned takeoff with complete briefing; a second only if runway/traffic/time permit.

Look for: Candidate uses correct aircraft-specific performance and configuration, achieves the applicable task standard, and explains reject/continue judgment clearly.

Watch / correct: Using a memorized generic speed -> locate and use the approved speed for this aircraft/loading.

Watch / correct: Skipping the runway/performance comparison -> recalculate before departure.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway/obstacle margin or an unmet aircraft condition. Reject only by the briefed approved procedure; simulated failures must be separately authorized and safely bounded.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.E; AFH chapter 6

Teach short-field landing and a safe go-around choice · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate choose the touchdown point, approved approach profile, wind correction and go-around gate. Role-play excessive focus on the touchdown mark and ask for a decision before the approach becomes unstable.

Student exercise: Brief and fly a stabilized short-field approach with the approved configuration and speeds. Explain the aim point versus touchdown point, coach the learner through roundout/landing, and apply approved stopping procedures only after maintaining directional control.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one coached attempt when traffic permits; any required go-around replaces the landing attempt.

Look for: Candidate satisfies applicable task accuracy while making a safe approach/landing decision and teaching directional control and energy management.

Watch / correct: Stretching a glide to reach the mark -> correct the energy/path while options exist or go around.

Watch / correct: Forcing the touchdown after an unstable approach -> go around; record why the original target was not met.

Stop / transition: Go around for an unstable path, unsafe wind, runway conflict or inadequate remaining distance. Never force a landing solely to achieve a target mark.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.F; AFH chapter 9

Teach soft-field takeoff technique and surface decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Require approved surface operations and aircraft technique. Use the briefing to compare actual soft/rough conditions with a simulated exercise on a suitable hard runway. Observe the candidate explain loading, drag and acceleration management.

Student exercise: Demonstrate the approved control positioning and liftoff/acceleration profile, then coach a learner attempt. Explain why liftoff and climb are separate phases and how approved speed/configuration establish a safe departure.

Practice: One demonstrated or coached takeoff; compare the omitted role verbally if time/traffic prevent a second.

Look for: Candidate follows the aircraft procedure, maintains directional control, and explains the transition from surface drag to safe acceleration and climb.

Watch / correct: Using an aggressive pitch change to leave the ground -> restore the approved attitude/profile.

Watch / correct: Beginning climb before adequate acceleration -> follow the aircraft departure sequence and protect stall margin.

Stop / transition: Do not use an unsuitable surface or operate outside aircraft limitations. Stop/reject using the briefed aircraft procedure if directional control or performance becomes unacceptable.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.C; AFH chapter 6

Teach soft-field landing without losing control · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved configuration and touchdown/rollout technique. Ask the candidate to explain how the surface and landing-gear design alter the procedure. Use a suitable runway for simulation when actual surface operations are inappropriate.

Student exercise: Demonstrate or coach a stabilized soft-field approach, touchdown and rollout using the aircraft procedure. Explain the required control positioning and why aircraft control and safe stopping remain

the primary objectives.

Practice: One demonstration and one coached attempt as conditions permit; a go-around replaces any unsafe attempt.

Look for: Candidate uses approved surface-specific technique, meets applicable task standards and provides concise coaching through touchdown and rollout.

Watch / correct: Adding unbriefed power during touchdown -> use the aircraft-approved technique and preserve runway margin.

Watch / correct: Releasing control positioning immediately on touchdown -> maintain the required surface/wind correction through rollout.

Stop / transition: Go around for an unstable approach, unsuitable surface or inadequate margin; do not land merely to demonstrate the surface technique.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.D; AFH chapter 9

Teach forward slip, sideslip and landing limitations · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to identify aircraft restrictions on slipping and flap/configuration combinations. Explain the different purposes of a forward slip and a sideslip before any demonstration.

Student exercise: At a suitable altitude, demonstrate the authorized slip and recover to coordinated flight. Teach how a landing application changes the flight path or wind correction, then coach an approved approach application only if stable and legal.

Practice: One altitude demonstration; one approach application only when authorized and needed.

Look for: Candidate distinguishes the two slip purposes, respects aircraft limits and restores the appropriate coordinated/landing condition before touchdown.

Watch / correct: Confusing a skid with a deliberate slip -> explain the control relationship and discontinue the skid.

Watch / correct: Using a slip to rescue an approach outside safe limits -> go around and rebuild the approach.

Stop / transition: Do not use a prohibited slip/configuration or accept stall/terrain margin loss. Abandon an unstable approach; no maneuver practice overrides the POH/AFM.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.M; AFH chapter 9

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate uses correct aircraft-specific performance and configuration, achieves the applicable task standard, and explains reject/continue judgment clearly.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Five task blocks provide focused exposure, not automatic mastery; carry the weakest takeoff/landing variant to lessons 12 or 15.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks VII.E, VII.F, VII.C, VII.D, VII.M; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 7 · Teach abnormal systems and a simulated forced landing

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-34 Air 12-28	[] Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline	Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist.
34-58 Air 28-52	[] Teach simulated engine failure and landing-option judgment	Maintain aircraft control using the approved glide/performance procedure.
58-70 Air 52-64	[] Teach an emergency descent with a recovery plan	Explain the priority and immediate actions from the aircraft checklist, demonstrate the authorized descent profile and recover at the briefed safe altitude.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 7

Prioritize control, a viable landing option and an applicable checklist while supervising a distracted learner.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Prioritize control, a viable landing option and an applicable checklist while supervising a distracted learner.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Select two aircraft-specific malfunctions; brief simulated power loss and descent recovery limits.
- In the parked briefing, teach location/use of emergency and survival equipment (ACS XII.D).
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Prioritize control, a viable landing option and an applicable checklist while supervising a distracted learner.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Choose two aircraft-applicable scenarios and state which indications are simulated. Require the candidate to distinguish an indication failure from a physical aircraft failure and to justify any checklist selection.

Student exercise: Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist. Teach a role-play learner to prioritize the aircraft, verify the diagnosis, request assistance and decide whether to continue, divert or land.

Practice: Two verbal/simulated scenarios with no unsafe system disablement; candidate leads one and coaches one.

Look for: Candidate selects applicable procedures without unsupported memory actions, maintains safe flight and teaches a reasoned landing/diversion decision.

Watch / correct: Choosing a checklist from one alarming indication -> cross-check and identify the actual problem.

Watch / correct: Pulling a breaker or moving a critical control without authorization -> stop simulation and use the approved aircraft procedure.

Stop / transition: Do not create a real malfunction to simulate one. Stop for actual abnormal indications, a prohibited equipment action, workload saturation or loss of flight-path control.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.C; AFH chapter 18; aircraft POH/AFM

Teach simulated engine failure and landing-option judgment · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Select a safe scenario location with a viable real landing option if power is unavailable. Brief simulation, who moves controls, recovery limits and manufacturer restrictions. Act as a learner who fixates on troubleshooting after maintaining flight-path safety has been established.

Student exercise: Maintain aircraft control using the approved glide/performance procedure. Explain landing-area choice and path planning, teach the applicable memory/checklist actions and communications, and recover from the simulation at the agreed safe point.

Practice: One candidate-led scenario and one coached planning segment; include a change in landing-option quality as a verbal event.

Look for: Candidate manages energy and a viable landing option first, prioritizes the appropriate checklist/communication, and intervenes before a role-play learner becomes unsafe.

Watch / correct: Troubleshooting before establishing the flight path -> fly and secure a landing option first.

Watch / correct: Keeping a poor initial landing site after conditions change -> reassess available choices without abrupt low-altitude maneuvering.

Stop / transition: No intentional engine shutdown in a single-engine airplane. Terminate while a safe recovery is possible; an actual failure immediately replaces the exercise with the real emergency response.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.B and Appendix 2; AFH chapter 18

Teach an emergency descent with a recovery plan · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Give a scenario such as smoke or pressurization concern and require the candidate to identify the applicable aircraft procedure. Brief the selected configuration, speed limit, clearing, terrain and level-off plan before demonstrating.

Student exercise: Explain the priority and immediate actions from the aircraft checklist, demonstrate the authorized descent profile and recover at the briefed safe altitude. Coach a learner through a second segment without creating an actual system emergency.

Practice: One demonstration and one short coached segment; one oral scenario comparison.

Look for: Candidate chooses the appropriate procedure, remains oriented, respects configuration/speed limits and teaches a controlled recovery/level-off.

Watch / correct: Diving before checking terrain/traffic -> maintain control and select a safe path.

Watch / correct: Inventing one descent configuration for every emergency -> identify and apply the specific aircraft procedure.

Stop / transition: Recover before a terrain/altitude limit, aircraft speed/configuration limit or traffic conflict. Actual smoke, fire or equipment failure ends the training scenario and requires the real procedure.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.A; AFH chapter 18

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate selects applicable procedures without unsupported memory actions, maintains safe flight and teaches a reasoned landing/diversion decision.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Unpracticed aircraft malfunctions remain briefing cases until a safe, applicable simulation is available.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks XII.C, XII.B, XII.A; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 8 · Teach steep turns, a spiral and power-off accuracy

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-36 Air 12-30	[] Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control	Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction.
36-54 Air 30-48	[] Teach a steep spiral around a selected landing reference	Demonstrate the applicable coordinated gliding spiral, adjusting bank for wind while controlling airspeed and the radius about the reference.
54-70 Air 48-64	[] Teach power-off accuracy landing and judgment	Demonstrate an energy-managed power-off accuracy approach using the aircraft-approved training condition.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 8

Explain the energy and wind-control differences among three demanding tasks and protect a safe landing decision.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Explain the energy and wind-control differences among three demanding tasks and protect a safe landing decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare distinct entry/recovery plans for steep turns and spiral; brief approved training power/propeller condition for accuracy landing.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Explain the energy and wind-control differences among three demanding tasks and protect a safe landing decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to brief the applicable bank target, entry speed, power and limitation from the ACS/aircraft documents. Demonstrate a safe learner tendency to lose altitude by discussing it or making only a small recoverable deviation.

Student exercise: Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction. Explain attitude, back-pressure, power and trim management, then coach a learner through a turn and rollout to the starting heading.

Practice: One demonstration each direction; one coached attempt in the weaker direction; reset between turns.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable commercial/instructor task standard and diagnoses the cause of altitude/airspeed deviations while retaining coordination and lookout.

Watch / correct: Adding more bank to correct an altitude loss -> diagnose the load/attitude problem before the correction.

Watch / correct: Rolling out late while explaining -> lead the rollout and divide attention between instruction and the flight path.

Stop / transition: Stop for aircraft load/speed limit, loss of coordination, significant flight-path deterioration or traffic conflict. The instructor takes control before the learner error becomes unsafe.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.A; AFH chapter 10

Teach a steep spiral around a selected landing reference · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a suitable ground reference, wind plan, emergency options and recovery floor. Ask the candidate to explain how the maneuver differs from a descending steep turn or spin. Observe manufacturer guidance for engine clearing and the prescribed configuration.

Student exercise: Demonstrate the applicable coordinated gliding spiral, adjusting bank for wind while controlling airspeed and the radius about the reference. Coach a learner segment, maintain traffic/terrain awareness and recover above the briefed limit.

Practice: One complete candidate demonstration only when altitude permits the required task; one coached segment. Carry additional circles to a later block instead of consuming recovery margin.

Look for: Candidate maintains task tolerances, explains wind-dependent bank and energy management, and leaves enough altitude for a normal recovery/return.

Watch / correct: Confusing a wind-driven track change with an airspeed problem -> separate bank/radius correction from pitch/airspeed control.

Watch / correct: Losing the recovery margin while counting turns -> prioritize recovery over the repetition target.

Stop / transition: Recover before the applicable ACS/aircraft floor, engine limitation, traffic conflict or loss of the safe landing option. Do not intentionally shut down a single-engine airplane.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.B; AFH chapter 10

Teach power-off accuracy landing and judgment · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Require a touchdown point, wind/energy assessment, approved power/propeller condition and safe landing options. Distinguish task performance assessment from the non-negotiable decision to avoid an unsafe landing.

Student exercise: Demonstrate an energy-managed power-off accuracy approach using the aircraft-approved training condition. Coach a learner attempt, explaining path adjustments and configuration timing. Make a landing/go-around decision while adequate options remain.

Practice: One demonstrated attempt and one coached attempt as pattern traffic permits; do not force both into the clock.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable task accuracy when landing safely and can explain why an attempt failed without sacrificing runway safety.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the mark and delaying a decision -> broaden the energy/runway scan and choose a safe outcome.

Watch / correct: Using a universal idle/propeller rule -> use the aircraft training procedure and Appendix 3 applicability.

Stop / transition: Do not force a landing. A safety-driven go-around is always available; record the training/test performance implications separately from the safety decision.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.O and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 9

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls

rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate meets the applicable commercial/instructor task standard and diagnoses the cause of altitude/airspeed deviations while retaining coordination and lookout.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.

- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Only one full accuracy-landing cycle may fit after the practice-area work; assign further coaching to review.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks IX.A, IX.B, VII.O; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 9 · Teach chandelles and the two different eights

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-36 Air 12-30	[] Teach the chandelle as a coordinated climbing reversal	Clear the area and use the approved entry condition.
36-54 Air 30-48	[] Teach lazy eights through pitch-bank timing and visual references	Demonstrate a coordinated pair of climbing/descending reversals using the selected references.
54-70 Air 48-64	[] Teach eights on pylons without trading away altitude margin	Demonstrate the approved pylon selection and entry, explain the visual reference movement, and coach a learner through one pair.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 9

Distinguish a climbing reversal, continuously changing flight path and groundspeed-related ground reference.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Distinguish a climbing reversal, continuously changing flight path and groundspeed-related ground reference.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare separate visual-reference diagrams and aircraft-authorized entry conditions for the three tasks.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Distinguish a climbing reversal, continuously changing flight path and groundspeed-related ground reference.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach the chandelle as a coordinated climbing reversal · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate explain the two halves of the maneuver, the planned bank/pitch progression and expected energy changes. Act as a learner who starts changing bank/pitch at the wrong stage; keep any physical deviation small and safe.

Student exercise: Clear the area and use the approved entry condition. Demonstrate the coordinated climbing reversal, narrating the change in pitch and bank through its two halves. Coach an opposite-direction attempt and use a normal transition at completion.

Practice: One candidate demonstration; one coached opposite-direction attempt; one targeted correction if time remains.

Look for: Candidate follows the applicable ACS profile, maintains coordination near the low-speed finish, and explains the geometry and energy change without stalling.

Watch / correct: Changing bank during the wrong half -> reset the visual reference and teach the sequence before repeating.

Watch / correct: Forcing the final pitch instead of recognizing aircraft response -> control angle of attack and finish safely.

Stop / transition: Terminate for a stall indication outside the briefed task condition, loss of coordination, aircraft restriction or inadequate practice altitude; return to normal flight.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.C; AFH chapter 10

Teach lazy eights through pitch-bank timing and visual references · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose useful visual reference points and describe the changing pitch/bank/airspeed pattern before flying. Role-play a learner who treats each half as a level turn.

Student exercise: Demonstrate a coordinated pair of climbing/descending reversals using the selected references. Explain which control and energy trend should be seen at each part of the arc. Coach a learner pair and compare symmetry, altitude, heading and airspeed at completion.

Practice: One demonstrated pair and one coached pair; one short segment repair if the setup remains suitable.

Look for: Candidate meets task tolerances and teaches smooth, continuously changing control rather than abrupt control checkpoints.

Watch / correct: Abruptly chasing a reference point -> restore smooth control changes and look ahead in the maneuver.

Watch / correct: Unequal halves without diagnosis -> compare starting conditions and timing before repeating.

Stop / transition: Stop for loss of coordination, an unbriefed stall warning, aircraft limitation or excessive flight-path deviation; stabilize before instruction continues.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.D; AFH chapter 10

Teach eights on pylons without trading away altitude margin · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Require suitable pylons, a safe operating area, wind assessment and emergency options. Ask the candidate to explain the groundspeed-related pivotal-altitude concept using actual units and the applicable guidance. Never use the exercise to justify unsafe low flight.

Student exercise: Demonstrate the approved pylon selection and entry, explain the visual reference movement, and coach a learner through one pair. Adjust the flight path as appropriate while preserving coordination, traffic scan and safe terrain separation.

Practice: One candidate pair and one coached pair if conditions permit; otherwise complete the explanation and defer the required flight practice.

Look for: Candidate keeps the intended visual reference relationship without fixation and can explain the effect of groundspeed on the required flight path.

Watch / correct: Using one computed altitude regardless of groundspeed -> connect changing groundspeed to the reference movement.

Watch / correct: Chasing a pylon downward toward terrain -> abandon the maneuver and select a safer setup.

Stop / transition: Exit for unsuitable terrain/pylon spacing, traffic, lack of safe forced-landing options or loss of terrain margin. No universal operational altitude is supplied.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.F; AFH chapter 10

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate follows the applicable ACS profile, maintains coordination near the low-speed finish, and explains the geometry and energy change without stalling.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.

- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Carry a weak maneuver into lesson 12; do not compress all three into abbreviated demonstrations that miss the teaching cycle.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks IX.C, IX.D, IX.F; applicable area notes and safety appendices
- FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 10 · Teach stall demonstrations and safe learner boundaries

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-34 Air 12-28	[] Teach load factor and accelerated-stall recognition	Clear the area, set the aircraft-approved entry condition, demonstrate the applicable turning entry, and recover at the first stall indication.
34-46 Air 28-40	[] Demonstrate cross-controlled-stall risk at altitude	Explain how an inappropriate rudder/aileron combination can produce a stall/spin threat.
46-58 Air 40-52	[] Demonstrate the elevator-trim-stall mechanism	Establish the authorized approach-trim condition at altitude.
58-70 Air 52-64	[] Teach secondary-stall prevention during recovery	Demonstrate the authorized secondary-stall sequence and recovery, explaining the renewed angle-of-attack problem.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 10

Demonstrate instructor-only familiarization tasks and coach only the learner-appropriate exercise.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Demonstrate instructor-only familiarization tasks and coach only the learner-appropriate exercise.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify aircraft authorization and separate recovery condition for each stall demonstration; prepare avoidance examples.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Demonstrate instructor-only familiarization tasks and coach only the learner-appropriate exercise.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach load factor and accelerated-stall recognition · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Use a ground sketch before flight to distinguish bank angle, load factor and angle of attack. Require approved entry configuration and a recovery at the first indication. Ask the candidate to describe a tightening-turn learner error rather than deliberately provoking an excessive load.

Student exercise: Clear the area, set the aircraft-approved entry condition, demonstrate the applicable turning entry, and recover at the first stall indication. Explain why the indicated airspeed can be higher than in an unaccelerated stall. Coach one safe repetition.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one supervised coached attempt, with a reset between attempts.

Look for: Candidate links load factor to stall risk, recognizes the first indication, makes a coordinated recovery, and never relies on an airspeed alone as stall protection.

Watch / correct: Confusing bank with load factor in every flight condition -> distinguish a coordinated level turn from unloaded flight.

Watch / correct: Continuing to pull after the first cue -> reduce angle of attack promptly and return to controlled flight.

Stop / transition: Recovery is at the first indication, not a prolonged/full accelerated stall. Stop for an exceeded load/configuration limit or a recovery-floor threat.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.E and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Demonstrate cross-controlled-stall risk at altitude · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief this as an instructor familiarization demonstration, not a pattern exercise for a private learner. Require the aircraft limitations and precise entry/recovery plan. Discuss the base-to-final overshoot scenario while remaining in a safe practice area.

Student exercise: Explain how an inappropriate rudder/aileron combination can produce a stall/spin threat. Demonstrate only the authorized ACS/aircraft procedure at a suitable altitude, recover as briefed, and teach a safer overshoot response: maintain control and go around.

Practice: One candidate demonstration if authorized; two verbal learner-error cases. Do not require the role-play learner to perform this demonstration.

Look for: Candidate explains the hazard and recognition cues, performs an authorized demonstration/recovery, and teaches avoidance without suggesting a low-altitude reenactment.

Watch / correct: Teaching rudder as a way to tighten the base-to-final turn -> teach coordinated flight and a go-around.

Watch / correct: Treating absent warning as permission to continue -> use coordination and aerodynamic cues as well as any warning system.

Stop / transition: Terminate for incipient spin, unexpected roll/yaw, aircraft restriction or recovery-margin loss. If aircraft authorization is absent, defer the flight demonstration to a suitable aircraft; verbal discussion does not complete a required flight task.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.F and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Demonstrate the elevator-trim-stall mechanism · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: On the ground, ask the candidate to explain how approach trim and a power change can produce unexpected pitch. Verify the aircraft-approved configuration and the recovery plan. Observe a demonstration rather than allowing an unbriefed learner surprise.

Student exercise: Establish the authorized approach-trim condition at altitude. Explain the pitch response to the prescribed power change, demonstrate the briefed recovery, and then describe the control/trim sequence that prevents the event during a real go-around.

Practice: One candidate demonstration; one coached, normal go-around-configuration discussion without inducing a second demonstration.

Look for: Candidate anticipates the pitch tendency, retains positive control and explains why immediate control precedes retrimming.

Watch / correct: Relying on trim as the primary flight control -> hold the required attitude with the controls, then trim.

Watch / correct: Letting a nose-up tendency develop while explaining -> control or recover first and resume instruction later.

Stop / transition: Stop for an unexpected pitch excursion, stall/spin threat, aircraft limitation or inadequate recovery margin. Use the approved procedure; no universal trim or power setting is supplied.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.G and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Teach secondary-stall prevention during recovery · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief that this demonstration includes a full stall under the ACS task, subject to aircraft authorization. Ask the candidate to explain why an overly aggressive recovery can stall the wing again. Keep the exercise distinct from an ordinary learner stall recovery.

Student exercise: Demonstrate the authorized secondary-stall sequence and recovery, explaining the renewed angle-of-attack problem. Then teach a normal recovery with controlled pitch/load and appropriate aircraft configuration management.

Practice: One authorized candidate demonstration, followed by one verbal comparison with a normal recovery.

Look for: Candidate recognizes the renewed stall, recovers without cascading into another event, and clearly teaches prevention.

Watch / correct: Trying to erase altitude loss with an abrupt pull -> recover lift/control before demanding additional load.

Watch / correct: Confusing a secondary stall with lingering buffet -> compare the renewed angle-of-attack increase and the aircraft response.

Stop / transition: Terminate for unexpected yaw/roll, inability to recover promptly or a threatened recovery floor. Do not continue a chain of stalls for repetition count.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.H and Appendix 3; AFH chapter 5

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate links load factor to stall risk, recognizes the first indication, makes a coordinated recovery, and never relies on an airspeed alone as stall protection.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- If aircraft restrictions prevent a required demonstration, use a suitable aircraft before claiming task completion; verbal review alone is not a flight pass.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks X.E, X.F, X.G, X.H; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 11 · Teach basic instrument control and unusual-attitude recovery

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-50 Air 12-44	[] Teach basic attitude instrument flight with a protected lookout	Demonstrate instrument straight-and-level flight, turns to headings, constant-airspeed climbs and descents with approved configurations.
50-70 Air 44-64	[] Teach unusual-attitude recognition and recovery	Identify the attitude and instrument trends, use the appropriate aircraft recovery sequence and return to controlled flight.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 11

Teach a purposeful instrument scan while the trainer protects the outside environment and recovery envelope.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach a purposeful instrument scan while the trainer protects the outside environment and recovery envelope.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Brief view-limiting-device use, qualified outside lookout, instrument presentation and safe attitude-entry/recovery limits.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Teach a purposeful instrument scan while the trainer protects the outside environment and recovery envelope.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach basic attitude instrument flight with a protected lookout · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief who provides the outside lookout and when/how the view-limiting device is used. Observe the candidate teach attitude/power relationships and an effective cross-check rather than an instrument-by-instrument fixation routine.

Student exercise: Demonstrate instrument straight-and-level flight, turns to headings, constant-airspeed climbs and descents with approved configurations. Coach one integrated learner sequence and verify that the learner can identify which indication supports each correction.

Practice: One integrated demonstration and one coached sequence covering all four tasks; repeat the weakest transition if time allows.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable task standard while teaching a purposeful scan and preserving positive control transfers and collision avoidance.

Watch / correct: Fixating on one indication -> return to an integrated cross-check and verify the flight path.

Watch / correct: Letting instruction replace the lookout -> stop the exercise until a qualified outside scan is restored.

Stop / transition: Remove the view restriction or terminate for traffic, unclear safety responsibilities, disorientation or control deterioration. The device must not restrict the observing instructor's view.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XI.A-D; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach unusual-attitude recognition and recovery · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief safe attitude entry, aircraft limits, recovery method and control transfer. Establish any unusual attitude gently within the authorized training envelope; never surprise the candidate with a dangerous or extreme upset.

Student exercise: Identify the attitude and instrument trends, use the appropriate aircraft recovery sequence and return to controlled flight. Explain the priority of angle of attack, bank, power and airspeed as applicable; coach a second scenario and diagnose the learner's scan error.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery scenario with a complete reset; partial-panel variation only after baseline proficiency.

Look for: Candidate recognizes the condition promptly, recovers by the applicable procedure and teaches why the chosen control sequence is appropriate.

Watch / correct: Moving controls from an unverified instrument impression -> confirm the attitude/trend promptly before the appropriate recovery.

Watch / correct: Pulling while a dangerous bank persists -> use the recovery sequence suited to the condition rather than a generic pull-up.

Stop / transition: Terminate for an aircraft limit, aggressive control response, recovery-margin threat or suspected actual instrument failure. Restore normal flight before discussing the event.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XI.E; Instrument Flying Handbook

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains the applicable task standard while teaching a purposeful scan and preserving positive control transfers and collision avoidance.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Carry weak instrument transitions to integrated review; do not add partial-panel work before the baseline scan is stable.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks XI.A, XI.B, XI.C, XI.D, XI.E; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Integration, specialized training and stage assessment

Repair deficiencies, complete authorized spin-related requirements and assess instructional competence.

Lesson 12 · Integrate teaching and repair weak elements

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-20 Air 00-14	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
20-35 Air 14-29	[] Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals	State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent.
35-50 Air 29-44	[] Teach wind correction through ground-reference maneuvers	Brief and demonstrate a rectangular course, S-turns or turns around a point as assigned.
50-65 Air 44-59	[] Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control	Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction.
65-80 Air 59-74	[] Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment	Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures.
80-95 Air 74-89	[] Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline	Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist.
95-115 Air 89-109	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
115-120 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 12

Use the candidate's prior evidence to choose a focused review, then practice instruction across ordinary and abnormal flight.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Use the candidate's prior evidence to choose a focused review, then practice instruction across ordinary and abnormal flight.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Select two priority deficiencies from lessons 1-11 and prepare a candidate-taught remedial plan.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Use the candidate's prior evidence to choose a focused review, then practice instruction across ordinary and abnormal flight.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach attitude, power, trim and the four fundamentals · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Demonstrate one change at a time: attitude, power, then trim. Give the candidate a desired flight path rather than a control command. Act as a learner who chases an instrument; require the candidate to redirect attention to an outside reference and then verify the result.

Student exercise: State the purpose and target; demonstrate level flight, a coordinated level turn, climb and descent. Hand over positively, coach the role-play learner through the same sequence, and ask the learner to explain which change produced the observed result.

Practice: One candidate demonstration and one coached learner attempt of each fundamental; prioritize a weak item for the remaining time.

Look for: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Watch / correct: Trimming before establishing the attitude/power combination -> stabilize the airplane first and then trim.

Watch / correct: Continuous instrument fixation -> restore an outside attitude reference and use the instruments to confirm it.

Stop / transition: Stop the exercise for uncoordinated control, an unsafe flight path, traffic conflict or loss of role clarity; reestablish ordinary flight before further explanation.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VIII.A-D; AFH chapter 3

Teach wind correction through ground-reference maneuvers · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to select a legal, suitable ground reference and explain wind, traffic, emergency landing options and altitude risks. Role-play a learner who corrects drift with rudder instead of a coordinated bank change.

Student exercise: Brief and demonstrate a rectangular course, S-turns or turns around a point as assigned. Explain wind-dependent bank changes and reference selection, coach a learner attempt, and compare the aircraft track with the intended ground path.

Practice: Two selected reference maneuvers: one demonstrated and one coached circuit each; the remaining variant is carried to review if time is insufficient.

Look for: Candidate maintains applicable ACS limits, keeps an outside scan and teaches the relationship between ground track, wind and bank without fixation on the point.

Watch / correct: Fixating on the reference -> restore the traffic/terrain scan and broaden the visual picture.

Watch / correct: Using a fixed bank around the entire ground path -> identify where groundspeed changes and adjust coordinated bank.

Stop / transition: Leave the exercise for unsuitable terrain/obstructions, people/property risk, traffic, an unavailable emergency option or a breached altitude margin; do not descend to make the diagram look better.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.E; AFH chapter 7

Teach coordinated steep turns and workload control · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Ask the candidate to brief the applicable bank target, entry speed, power and limitation from the ACS/aircraft documents. Demonstrate a safe learner tendency to lose altitude by discussing it or making only a small recoverable deviation.

Student exercise: Clear the area; establish the entry condition; demonstrate a coordinated turn in each direction. Explain attitude, back-pressure, power and trim management, then coach a learner through a turn and rollout to the starting heading.

Practice: One demonstration each direction; one coached attempt in the weaker direction; reset between turns.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable commercial/instructor task standard and diagnoses the cause of altitude/airspeed deviations while retaining coordination and lookout.

Watch / correct: Adding more bank to correct an altitude loss -> diagnose the load/attitude problem before the correction.

Watch / correct: Rolling out late while explaining -> lead the rollout and divide attention between instruction and the flight path.

Stop / transition: Stop for aircraft load/speed limit, loss of coordination, significant flight-path deterioration or traffic conflict. The instructor takes control before the learner error becomes unsafe.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 IX.A; AFH chapter 10

Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the candidate brief pattern entry, wind correction, runway choice, stabilized approach criteria and a positive control-transfer plan. Act as a learner who overlooks a checklist or misjudges spacing; use a verbal prompt instead of creating an unsafe approach.

Student exercise: Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures. Demonstrate one approach, coach the next, explain workload management and make a planned go-around.

Make the landing/go-around decision early enough to preserve options.

Practice: One demonstration circuit, one coached circuit and one planned go-around as traffic/ATC permit; no forced pattern count.

Look for: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Watch / correct: Talking through final while losing airspeed/alignment -> shorten instruction, regain a stabilized approach or go around.

Watch / correct: Treating an ATC instruction as permission to exceed a limit -> request an alternative and protect the aircraft margin.

Stop / transition: Go around or discontinue for an unstable approach, unsafe spacing, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or unclear control responsibility. Touch-and-go operations require aircraft/airport authorization.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.A-B and VII.A-B,N; AFH chapters 6, 8-9

Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Choose two aircraft-applicable scenarios and state which indications are simulated. Require the candidate to distinguish an indication failure from a physical aircraft failure and to justify any checklist selection.

Student exercise: Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist. Teach a role-play learner to prioritize the aircraft, verify the diagnosis, request assistance and decide whether to continue, divert or land.

Practice: Two verbal/simulated scenarios with no unsafe system disablement; candidate leads one and coaches one.

Look for: Candidate selects applicable procedures without unsupported memory actions, maintains safe flight and teaches a reasoned landing/diversion decision.

Watch / correct: Choosing a checklist from one alarming indication -> cross-check and identify the actual problem.

Watch / correct: Pulling a breaker or moving a critical control without authorization -> stop simulation and use the approved aircraft procedure.

Stop / transition: Do not create a real malfunction to simulate one. Stop for actual abnormal indications, a prohibited equipment action, workload saturation or loss of flight-path control.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.C; AFH chapter 18; aircraft POH/AFM

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate maintains the briefed commercial-level task tolerances while explaining cause and effect, then identifies and corrects a learner deviation without losing the traffic scan.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- The listed review is a default; replace an equal-time block with a documented weak task before dispatch. Record the replacement in the printed/session notes; a replaced item is not assessed on this flight.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, IX.E, IX.A, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.N, XII.C; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 13 · Complete spin instruction in a suitable airplane

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-18 Air 00-12	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
18-70 Air 12-64	[] Complete authorized stall/spin instructional training	Teach stall awareness, coordination and spin avoidance.
70-85 Air 64-79	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
85-90 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 13

Complete the applicable spin-related instructional training under a separately qualified instructor and authorized aircraft conditions.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Complete the applicable spin-related instructional training under a separately qualified instructor and authorized aircraft conditions.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Verify 61.183(i) applicability and endorsement evidence; arrange a spin-approved aircraft/loading and qualified trainer.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Complete the applicable spin-related instructional training under a separately qualified instructor and authorized aircraft conditions.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Complete authorized stall/spin instructional training · 52 minutes

Teach / coach: Use a separately suitable spin-approved airplane and a qualified instructor. Verify the exact loading, limitations and manufacturer entry/recovery procedures before dispatch. Train and assess the candidate to explain, demonstrate and correct the required spin-related subjects; any endorsement is an authorized-instructor decision.

Student exercise: Teach stall awareness, coordination and spin avoidance. With the qualified instructor, perform only the approved entry, spin and recovery procedures within the agreed limits. Explain recognition and control priorities while maintaining orientation; complete the required ground/flight review for an endorsement.

Practice: Qualified instructor selects the required demonstrations and repetitions for proficiency; the time allocation never guarantees an endorsement.

Look for: Qualified instructor independently finds the candidate proficient to teach the applicable stall-awareness, spin-entry, spin and recovery subjects and documents the required training/endorsement.

Watch / correct: Applying a generic recovery mnemonic without checking the aircraft procedure -> use the approved manufacturer sequence.

Watch / correct: Assuming a familiar model or utility-category label proves authorization -> verify the specific airplane, loading and limitations.

Stop / transition: No intentional spin without explicit aircraft/loading authorization, qualified instruction and adequate recovery margin. This module is prohibited in multiengine airplanes. Defer to a suitable aircraft if any gate fails.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 X.I; 14 CFR 61.183(i); AFH chapter 5

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.

- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Qualified instructor independently finds the candidate proficient to teach the applicable stall-awareness, spin-entry, spin and recovery subjects and documents the required training/endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- If a suitable aircraft/instructor or safe conditions are unavailable, defer this lesson and the endorsement; do not substitute a multiengine airplane.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks X.I; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Lesson 14 · Stage assessment: teach, supervise and diagnose

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min check | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Assess normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-20 Air 00-14	[] Assess the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
20-45 Air 14-39	[] Assess normal operations and landing judgment	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
45-75 Air 39-69	[] Assess maneuver instruction and risk management	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
75-95 Air 69-89	[] Assess abnormal-event instruction and instrument control	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
95-115 Air 89-109	[] Assess return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
115-120 Ground	[] Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 14

Assess the selected instructional tasks without teaching new technique; separate aircraft performance from teaching competence.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Assess the selected instructional tasks without teaching new technique; separate aircraft performance from teaching competence.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Review the current ACS task-selection notes, spin-training evidence and candidate's unobserved items.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Assess the selected instructional tasks without teaching new technique; separate aircraft performance from teaching competence.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Assess normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Assess the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Assess normal operations and landing judgment · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Select appropriate preflight/start/taxi teaching and at least the required takeoff/landing tasks for the applicant's class and rating status. Include a stabilized-approach/go-around decision. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable task standards, provides effective instruction and identifies a safe learner error without prompting; selected ground tasks are assessed in briefing/preflight/taxi, not counted as airborne practice.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V-VII

Assess maneuver instruction and risk management · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Choose the class-applicable ACS selection after reviewing the candidate's prior evidence. State which maneuvers are selected and which remain for a later check; do not attempt every option in one block. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate meets the relevant commercial/instructor standard, explains the task correctly and diagnoses the learner's error while protecting coordination, traffic and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VIII-X

Assess abnormal-event instruction and instrument control · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Select an aircraft-applicable emergency scenario and an appropriate basic-instrument task. Assess emergency equipment/survival knowledge in the preflight briefing; simulate malfunctions only by approved safe means. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate prioritizes safe flight, chooses the applicable checklist, teaches the selected instrument/emergency task and makes a defensible landing/diversion decision without coaching.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XI-XII

Assess return, final landing and safe runway exit · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Assessment is independent: safety intervention, prompting or an unobserved required item cannot be recorded as a satisfactory task.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate meets the applicable task standards, provides effective instruction and identifies a safe learner error without prompting; selected ground tasks are assessed in briefing/preflight/taxi, not counted as airborne practice.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Assign remediation and a subsequent assessment for any unsuccessful or unobserved item; this stage check is not a practical-test endorsement by itself.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks V.A, V.B, V.C, V.D, V.F, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.E, VII.F, VII.N, VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, IX.A, IX.B, IX.C, IX.D, IX.E, IX.F, X.A, X.B, X.C, X.D, X.E, X.F, X.G, X.H, XI.A, XI.B, XI.C, XI.D, XI.E, XII.A, XII.B, XII.C, XII.D; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Aviation Instructor's Handbook - source page Chapters 5-10: planning, demonstration-performance, assessment and risk instruction - FAA-H-8083-9B (2020)

Mission management and practical-test preparation

Integrate teaching across a mission and evaluate readiness without letting a clock substitute for proficiency.

Lesson 15 · Manage an instructional mission

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-20 Air 00-14	[] Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
20-35 Air 14-29	[] Teach VFR mission monitoring and a diversion decision	Verify present position and compare actual time/fuel with the preflight plan.
35-55 Air 29-49	[] Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment	Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures.
55-75 Air 49-69	[] Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline	Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist.
75-95 Air 69-89	[] Teach simulated engine failure and landing-option judgment	Maintain aircraft control using the approved glide/performance procedure.
95-115 Air 89-109	[] Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
115-120 Ground	[] Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 15

Lead a VFR instructional cross-country/local mission with planning changes, learner workload and a realistic diversion decision.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Lead a VFR instructional cross-country/local mission with planning changes, learner workload and a realistic diversion decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Prepare a VFR route, destination/alternate options and current weather/NOTAM/fuel/performance plan; verify actual aircraft capability before the candidate teaches mission decisions.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Lead a VFR instructional cross-country/local mission with planning changes, learner workload and a realistic diversion decision.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Teach normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks · 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Teach the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Teach VFR mission monitoring and a diversion decision · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign a briefed VFR route and one verbal change in weather, fuel, airspace or destination availability. Observe the candidate teach position verification, actual aircraft performance and a workable diversion. Role-play a learner who keeps the original destination after its margins deteriorate; do not create an actual emergency or airspace violation.

Student exercise: Verify present position and compare actual time/fuel with the preflight plan. Explain the route, airspace, terrain, weather and available landing options; choose a suitable diversion, estimate its fuel/time/performance, request help or an amended ATC instruction when appropriate, then coach the learner through the next safe action.

Practice: One candidate-led position/fuel check and one coached diversion decision; a verbal destination change is enough when a physical diversion would consume the return reserve.

Look for: Candidate teaches a defensible continue/divert/land decision using current information and aircraft capability, maintains a safe flight path, and states what would change the decision.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward a destination because it was in the original plan -> reassess current weather, fuel, terrain and landing options.

Watch / correct: Programming a diversion before securing control and position -> fly, verify position, then manage navigation and communication.

Stop / transition: Actual ATC instructions, airspace clearance, weather and aircraft margins govern. End the script if workload, fuel reserve, position uncertainty or a deteriorating landing option threatens the safe return.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 II.G-I, III.C; Pilot's Handbook of Aeronautical Knowledge, navigation and aeronautical decision making

Teach normal pattern operations and crosswind judgment · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Let the candidate brief pattern entry, wind correction, runway choice, stabilized approach criteria and a positive control-transfer plan. Act as a learner who overlooks a checklist or misjudges spacing; use a verbal prompt instead of creating an unsafe approach.

Student exercise: Teach a normal/crosswind departure and approach using the actual airport procedures. Demonstrate one approach, coach the next, explain workload management and make a planned go-around. Make the landing/go-around decision early enough to preserve options.

Practice: One demonstration circuit, one coached circuit and one planned go-around as traffic/ATC permit; no forced pattern count.

Look for: Candidate keeps the airplane within task standards while teaching runway alignment, energy, spacing, communication and a timely go-around.

Watch / correct: Talking through final while losing airspeed/alignment -> shorten instruction, regain a stabilized approach or go around.

Watch / correct: Treating an ATC instruction as permission to exceed a limit -> request an alternative and protect the aircraft margin.

Stop / transition: Go around or discontinue for an unstable approach, unsafe spacing, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or unclear control responsibility. Touch-and-go operations require aircraft/airport authorization.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.A-B and VII.A-B,N; AFH chapters 6, 8-9

Teach system-failure recognition and checklist discipline · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Choose two aircraft-applicable scenarios and state which indications are simulated. Require the candidate to distinguish an indication failure from a physical aircraft failure and to justify any checklist selection.

Student exercise: Explain the indications, control/flight-path consequences and appropriate aircraft checklist. Teach a role-play learner to prioritize the aircraft, verify the diagnosis, request assistance and decide whether to continue, divert or land.

Practice: Two verbal/simulated scenarios with no unsafe system disablement; candidate leads one and coaches one.

Look for: Candidate selects applicable procedures without unsupported memory actions, maintains safe flight and teaches a reasoned landing/diversion decision.

Watch / correct: Choosing a checklist from one alarming indication -> cross-check and identify the actual problem.

Watch / correct: Pulling a breaker or moving a critical control without authorization -> stop simulation and use the approved aircraft procedure.

Stop / transition: Do not create a real malfunction to simulate one. Stop for actual abnormal indications, a prohibited equipment action, workload saturation or loss of flight-path control.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.C; AFH chapter 18; aircraft POH/AFM

Teach simulated engine failure and landing-option judgment · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Select a safe scenario location with a viable real landing option if power is unavailable. Brief simulation, who moves controls, recovery limits and manufacturer restrictions. Act as a learner who fixates on troubleshooting after maintaining flight-path safety has been established.

Student exercise: Maintain aircraft control using the approved glide/performance procedure. Explain landing-area choice and path planning, teach the applicable memory/checklist actions and communications, and recover from the simulation at the agreed safe point.

Practice: One candidate-led scenario and one coached planning segment; include a change in landing-option quality as a verbal event.

Look for: Candidate manages energy and a viable landing option first, prioritizes the appropriate checklist/communication, and intervenes before a role-play learner becomes unsafe.

Watch / correct: Troubleshooting before establishing the flight path -> fly and secure a landing option first.

Watch / correct: Keeping a poor initial landing site after conditions change -> reassess available choices without abrupt low-altitude maneuvering.

Stop / transition: No intentional engine shutdown in a single-engine airplane. Terminate while a safe recovery is possible; an actual failure immediately replaces the exercise with the real emergency response.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XII.B and Appendix 2; AFH chapter 18

Teach return, final landing and safe runway exit · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Teach after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before

debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Task mastery is based on observed performance; completing the time block or reading the checklist alone does not complete the lesson.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate teaches a defensible continue/divert/land decision using current information and aircraft capability, maintains a safe flight path, and states what would change the decision.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Repeat a weak mission decision with a new scenario before the practical-test assessment. Extend or defer work when a safe diversion and return will not fit the planned block.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks II.G-I, III.C, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.N, XII.C, XII.B; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

Lesson 16 · Mock instructor practical test

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min check | Brief 20 | Preflight 20 | Debrief 10

Original SUAREZ.CFI pacing proposal; no publisher target or regulatory minimum. Repeat/extend for proficiency.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-06 Ground	[] Assess normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks	Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control...
06-20 Air 00-14	[] Assess the briefed takeoff, climb and transit	Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe...
20-45 Air 14-39	[] Assess normal operations and landing judgment	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
45-75 Air 39-69	[] Assess maneuver instruction and risk management	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
75-95 Air 69-89	[] Assess abnormal-event instruction and instrument control	Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified...
95-115 Air 89-109	[] Assess return, final landing and safe runway exit	Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe...
115-120 Ground	[] Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings	Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports...

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 16

Use an independently selected plan and learner-error cases to assess readiness against the applicable current ACS.

Aircraft-neutral instructor guidance. Actual aircraft authority, current rules/standards, weather, terrain and instructor judgment control each flight.

Objectives

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Use an independently selected plan and learner-error cases to assess readiness against the applicable current ACS.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Before the flight

- Candidate supplies an organized lesson plan and relevant qualification/endorsement records; trainer selects class-applicable tasks.
- Before dispatch, enter/brief actual aircraft targets, configuration, authorized simulation methods and task recovery limits from the POH/AFM, current standards and operator procedures.
- Use the separate preflight budget for inspection, documents/equipment and current weather/NOTAM/performance checks; do not count this as airborne practice.

Briefing • 20 minutes

- Teach the named tasks through purpose, setup, demonstration, learner practice and an evidence-based assessment.
- Use an independently selected plan and learner-error cases to assess readiness against the applicable current ACS.
- Maintain aircraft control, positive flight-control exchanges, traffic protection and aircraft-specific risk/recovery limits while instructing.

Assess normal taxi, runway boundaries and checks • 6 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate teach the aircraft start/checklist and airport route. Use a verbal learner error about a hold-short point, control positioning or system indication; avoid creating a real incursion or control error. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the diagram/clearance and wind-control positioning; uses the actual checklist, monitors the aircraft systems, maintains directional control and stops before uncertainty turns into movement.

Practice: One actual taxi/check sequence; brief aircraft start/preflight outside the logged flight-time block.

Look for: Candidate teaches the reason for checks and runway boundaries, not merely a memorized route; airport movement stays safe.

Watch / correct: Doing checklist/programming with inadequate lookout -> stop before the head-down task.

Watch / correct: Assuming the next runway crossing is authorized -> verify clearance and markings before moving.

Stop / transition: Stop for unclear crossing authority, abnormal indications, unsafe distraction or directional-control concern.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V.A-D,F; VI.A; current airport diagram; aircraft checklist

Assess the briefed takeoff, climb and transit · 14 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Have the candidate state runway/wind/performance and the approved departure/reject plan. Observe aircraft control and concise instruction; any learner-error role-play remains within a safe envelope. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate explains the approved configuration/speeds and departure path, teaches the selected takeoff, completes climb checks and navigates to the safe practice area with a traffic scan and clear control exchanges.

Practice: One assigned takeoff and transit; return reserve takes precedence over adding another maneuver.

Look for: Candidate teaches the aircraft-specific departure correctly and reaches the practice area with control, checklist and traffic awareness intact.

Watch / correct: Using a generic target speed/configuration -> identify the approved aircraft value before departure.

Watch / correct: Long explanation during a critical flight-path change -> shorten instruction and fly first.

Stop / transition: Do not depart with inadequate performance/runway margin. Stop the exercise for traffic, weather, aircraft limit or loss of clear control responsibility.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VII.A,E,N as applicable; aircraft takeoff/climb checklist

Assess normal operations and landing judgment · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Select appropriate preflight/start/taxi teaching and at least the required takeoff/landing tasks for the applicant's class and rating status. Include a stabilized-approach/go-around decision. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate meets the applicable task standards, provides effective instruction and identifies a safe learner error without prompting; selected ground tasks are assessed in briefing/preflight/taxi, not counted as airborne practice.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 V-VII

Assess maneuver instruction and risk management · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Choose the class-applicable ACS selection after reviewing the candidate's prior evidence. State which maneuvers are selected and which remain for a later check; do not attempt every option in one block. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate meets the relevant commercial/instructor standard, explains the task correctly and diagnoses the learner's error while protecting coordination, traffic and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VIII-X

Assess abnormal-event instruction and instrument control · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess without coaching new technique. Select an aircraft-applicable emergency scenario and an appropriate basic-instrument task. Assess emergency equipment/survival knowledge in the preflight briefing; simulate malfunctions only by approved safe means. Record pilot performance, teaching accuracy, learner-error diagnosis and risk decisions separately. Intervene immediately for safety; intervention ends that assessed attempt.

Student exercise: Candidate briefs the task, demonstrates while explaining, supervises the trainer acting as learner, identifies the scripted error and states a justified assessment/correction. Maintain checklist discipline, control transfers and outside/flight-path scan throughout.

Practice: One assessed demonstration and one learner-error case for each selected task; unobserved items remain unobserved.

Look for: Candidate prioritizes safe flight, chooses the applicable checklist, teaches the selected instrument/emergency task and makes a defensible landing/diversion decision without coaching.

Watch / correct: Deviation outside the task standard -> record the evidence and assign remediation; do not coach it into a pass.

Watch / correct: Inaccurate explanation or missed learner hazard -> record the teaching deficiency and stop before it becomes an aircraft-control hazard.

Stop / transition: Stop for safety intervention, aircraft/clearance limit, traffic or unsuitable conditions. Record deferred tasks separately from unsuccessful tasks; the clock does not grant completion.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XI-XII

Assess return, final landing and safe runway exit · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Require the candidate to choose an appropriate airport/pattern entry, wind/runway and landing plan. Observe concise teaching and a timely go-around decision; keep the final landing independent of a maneuver repetition count. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate teaches arrival/pattern communication and spacing, uses the approved descent/landing checklist, flies a stable approach, makes a safe landing/go-around decision and controls rollout/runway exit.

Practice: One final landing or safe go-around/alternative; pattern module repetitions occur within their own allocated blocks.

Look for: Candidate maintains the applicable landing standard and supervises the learner without sacrificing spacing, runway alignment or energy control.

Watch / correct: Rushing the return to meet the timer -> maintain a safe return/landing reserve and defer incomplete practice.

Watch / correct: Unstable approach or runway conflict -> go around rather than force completion.

Stop / transition: Go around/choose a safe alternative for unstable approach, runway conflict, wind/aircraft limit or inadequate landing margin.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 VI.B,VII.B,F,N as applicable; aircraft landing checklist

Assess after-landing, shutdown and postflight findings · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Assess independently without coaching new technique; safety intervention ends the assessed attempt. Observe the candidate wait until clear of the runway to teach noncritical checks, then supervise the actual parking/shutdown/secure sequence. Ask what equipment discrepancy or learner issue needs follow-up. Assess independently and record errors; do not coach new technique.

Student exercise: Candidate announces runway-clear status, teaches the approved after-landing actions, taxis/parks safely, completes the shutdown/secure procedure and reports aircraft discrepancies before debrief.

Practice: One actual after-landing/taxi/parking sequence; discussion after shutdown belongs to the separate debrief.

Look for: Aircraft is secured by its checklist; candidate teaches workload timing and identifies unresolved equipment/safety concerns.

Watch / correct: Starting a noncritical checklist on the runway -> exit safely first.

Watch / correct: Calling the flight complete without reporting a discrepancy -> document/report the issue through the operator's process.

Stop / transition: Stop movement/checks for a taxi conflict or real abnormality; no instruction takes priority over aircraft control and safe parking.

Reference: FAA-S-ACS-25 XIV.A; aircraft after-landing/shutdown checklist

Completion criteria

- Candidate performs the selected applicable tasks to the current certificate/rating skill standard while giving accurate, effective instruction.
- Candidate recognizes and diagnoses learner errors, intervenes before unsafe flight and provides a justified performance assessment.
- Assessment is independent: safety intervention, prompting or an unobserved required item cannot be recorded as a satisfactory task.
- Observed task outcome: Candidate meets the applicable task standards, provides effective instruction and identifies a safe learner error without prompting; selected ground tasks are assessed in briefing/preflight/taxi, not counted as airborne practice.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Candidate first explains which flight/teaching outcome was strongest and identifies one error with its cause.
- Compare trainer evidence with candidate self-assessment; distinguish pilot performance from explanation, learner supervision and risk judgment.
- Review the lesson-specific carry-forward item and choose the next practice or assessment before dispatch.
- Use the first task block's error/recovery evidence to explain whether the candidate's next learner lesson should repeat, simplify or progress.

Repeat or carry forward

- Complete required tasks not sampled in this mock on a separate flight. Only an authorized instructor may make the final proficiency/endorsement decision.

Study and sources

Read the applicable task, area note and safety requirements

Prepare a brief demonstration-performance lesson and learner-error case

Review current FAA handbooks and applicable addenda

Flight Instructor for Airplane Category ACS - source page Tasks V.A, V.B, V.C, V.D, V.F, VI.A, VI.B, VII.A, VII.B, VII.E, VII.F, VII.N, VIII.A, VIII.B, VIII.C, VIII.D, IX.A, IX.B, IX.C, IX.D, IX.E, IX.F, X.A, X.B, X.C, X.D, X.E, X.F, X.G, X.H, XI.A, XI.B, XI.C, XI.D, XI.E, XII.A, XII.B, XII.C, XII.D; applicable area notes and safety appendices - FAA-S-ACS-25, April 2024

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